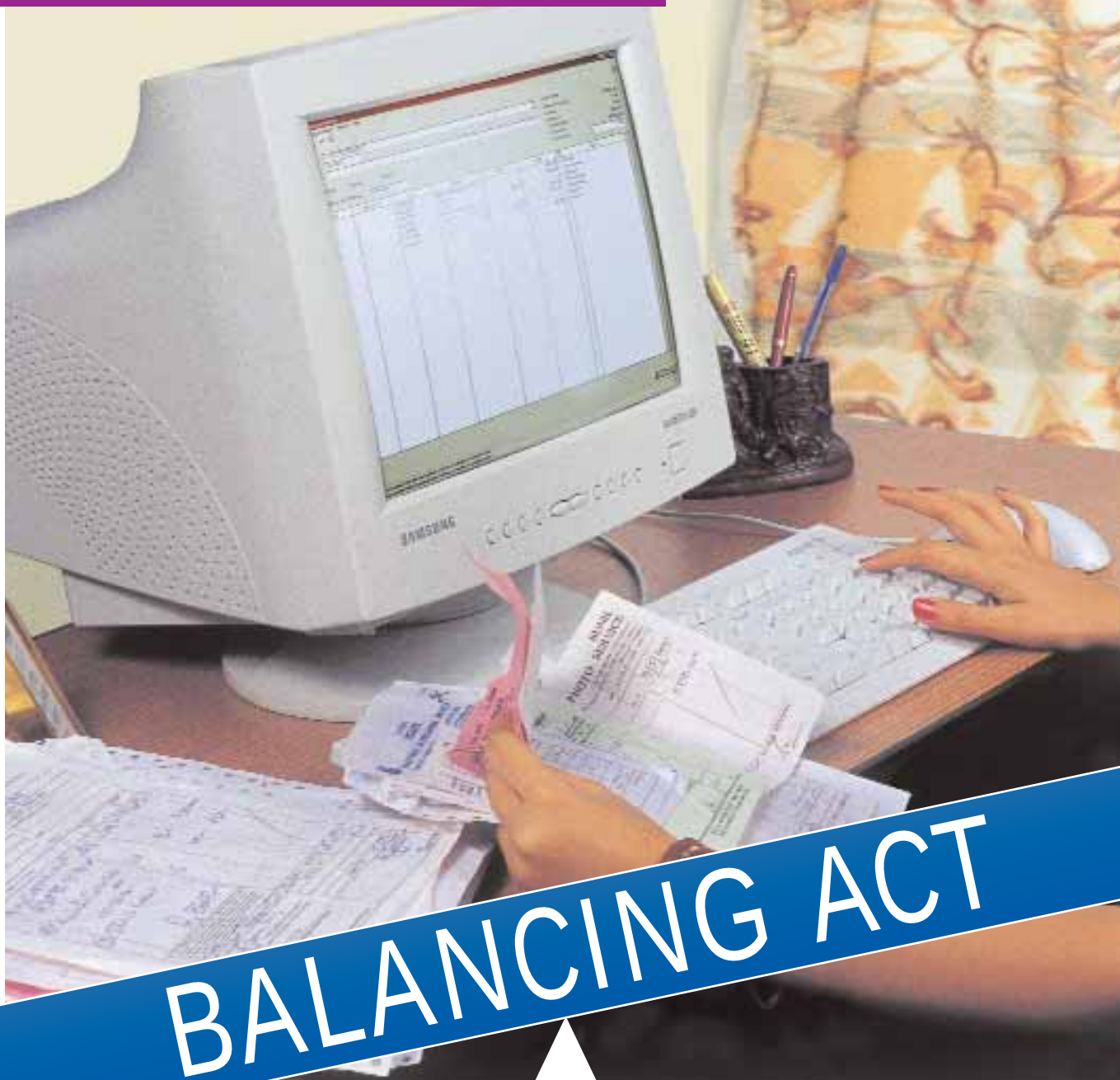


IN TEST: 10 ACCOUNTING SOFTWARE



BALANCING ACT

Photograph: Rahul Sharma

Accounts in a big mess? Whip them into shape with financial accounting software

MITUL MEHTA

The sheer thought of keeping accounts can make even the biggest business stalwart dizzy, considering the tedious nature of the work and the enormous effort that goes into maintaining account books and preserving them for the 10 years required by the law. Little wonder that most people have switched over to using computers for this purpose.

Of course, who hasn't wished that financial accountancy programs would be easier to oper-

ate, that the interface would be simpler, or that it wouldn't be so darn difficult to figure out how the whole thing worked?

Over the years, software developers have been trying to keep the customer satisfied by making fundamental changes to make their software more user-friendly. They have also been trying to zoom in on the specific needs of different types of users, because in practice, these software have to cater to a large variety of customers, from home and SoHo (small office

